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3. INJA's vodka-based cocktail called Bouquet

4. At JW Marriott Aerocity's Adrift Kaya, a cocktail comes with matcha air foam

5. At Gurgaon's Japonico, the matcha cocktail is called Union

it's visually appealing. "The cocktail has become one of our top five bestsellers. On average, we sell 80-100 servings a week. Guests are always curious to try it," says Nikhil Singh Bhandari, Beverage Director, Japonico. At Call Me Ten, a modern Japanese Izakaya in Delhi, the Espresso Martini comes with matcha.

Matcha's Instagram-worthy appearance is undoubtedly a part of its appeal. Mumbai's newly opened The Dimsum Room has reinterpreted the classic Salty Dog cocktail with a matcha layer, giving it a dramatic dual-colour separation, enhancing its Instagram appeal.

So, are matcha cocktails just a phase or a trend that is here to

stay? "It's like avocado. It's completely alien to us, and everyone thought it will be just a phase, but it became so popular. Similarly, matcha is not just a fad, it's trend that will stay," says Vikas Kumar, General Manager, New Delhi-based bars PCO and The Director's Room.

Of course, there are others who don't really see its appeal. "Matcha is the most marketable ingredient today, mostly at coffee shops and now also at bars. But any serious bar enthusiast will see through matcha on the menu. I can see how matcha froth and air can add to the visual appeal of a drink even when it doesn't need any froth or air. The oversold tea health benefits also act in its

favour," says Tarun Sibal, chef and co-owner of two bars, New Delhi-based Khi Khi and Goa-based Titlie.

Then there are those who feel matcha is being overused and would therefore prefer to use other teas. At Bangalore-based Lupa, bar manager Mo Thafseer prefers to work with other unique and underrated Japanese and Taiwanese teas such as Genmaicha and Lapsang Souchong. "They offer incredible nuance and character without being overdone," he says.

Love it or hate it, there is no denying that the vibrant green powder tea is here to stay! **BT**

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